SOC-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Starting and maintaining contact

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Explore the contact the person wants, choose a small initiative, and consider reciprocity and boundaries over time. The goal is a wanted, suitable relationship, not more friends or forced sociability.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Respect unwillingness, refusal and no response without repeated approaches or pressure. Do not require personal disclosure, contact with strangers or renewal of a harmful relationship. Wanting privacy or solitude is not itself a problem.

Reusing existing material

SOC-03 supports wording a request and SOC-04 a disagreement. Here we explore initiative, mutual response and the desired amount of contact; existing activity sheets can help choose a setting.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Maya wants to stay in touch with a familiar friend and suggests a short call at a time that suits both. When the friend is unavailable, Maya respects this and chooses how to care for herself.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

Mindful Path

SOC-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What relationship would I like to nurture, and how much?

2 | Question for discussion

What possible initiative fits our familiarity and context?

3 | Question for discussion

What can I offer without expecting agreement?

4 | Question for discussion

What limits on time and sharing matter to me?

5 | Question for discussion

How will I consider reciprocity without measuring every response?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If taking initiative creates pressure, reduce its scope or only rehearse it. No response proves nothing about personal worth, but is also not an invitation to contact someone repeatedly.

Mindful Path

SOC-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

An adult helps choose a familiar relationship and safe setting. Inviting someone to one game is possible; do not require the child to be everyone's friend or face rejection alone.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Respect online and in-person relationships while exploring privacy and safety. Do not set a target number of friends or require disclosure to belong.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Consider availability, work, caring for others and different wishes for contact. Reciprocity is explored over the relationship, not by counting messages.

OA | Older adults

Ask about wanted relationships without assuming loneliness. A call, visit or another setting can be chosen for accessibility and preference, without requiring digital contact.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

Mindful Path

SOC-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a small, voluntary initiative in a familiar, safe setting. Sending an actual message is optional; wording can be prepared and its suitability explored in the session.

At the next session

Explore fit, comfort and reciprocity rather than successful persuasion. Less contact or time alone may suit the person's wishes.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Assertiveness

Mindful Path